

◆ CHAPTER 05 • RETURN

FIRST LIGHT – the full daily protocol

DATE Sun 13 Sep 2026

HM SEP 27 • TMM JAN 17 • 70.3 FEB 17 • 100K DEC 27 • IRONMAN JAN 28

THE COVENANT – THE 5 THAT ANCHOR THE DAY

- ☐ WAKE before 4:30 AM
- ☐ MEDITATION – Brahma Muhurta, 4:45
- ☐ WORKOUT
- ☐ JOURNAL
- ☐ SLEEP 6.5H+ – lights out 9:45 PM

The wake is won at **lights-out**, not at the alarm – that is the one to defend. Miss it and tomorrow is already decided.

DAY MODE – PICK ONE AT WAKE. ALL THREE KEEP THE STREAK.

- ☐ FULL everything on this sheet
- ☐ KEYSTONE the ★ items only – late wake, travel, heavy load
- ☐ ANCHOR the Covenant only – ill, wrecked, broken sleep
- A smaller day is not a failed day. KEYSTONE and ANCHOR hold the streak and carry **no penance**. The only failed day is an unlogged one.

IF THE MORNING IS ALREADY LOST – DO NOT RUN THE CHAIN FROM WHERE YOU WOKE

1. Drop to **KEYSTONE**. Do not attempt the full chain – it will eat the 9:00 open.
2. Sit **3 minutes** in place of the full Brahma Muhurta block. Three minutes counts.
3. Rejoin at the next **FIXED** event below. Everything between them is compressible.

FIXED – 6:00 in the water • 9:00 market open • 7:00 PM laptop close + phone off • 9:45 PM lights out

Never push rituals into the night to “finish” the day. That buys one checkbox with tomorrow’s morning – it is how nine days get lost.

◇ RETURN RAMP – BACK FROM THE FEVER BREAK (SEP 4–12). THE RAMP COSTS STUDY TIME, NEVER RITUAL TIME.

W1	Sep 13–19	wake 4:30 AM	lights out 9:45 PM	Study 1+2 → 40 min ◀ THIS WEEK
W2	Sep 20–26	wake 4:00 AM	lights out 9:15 PM	Study 1+2 → 65 min
W3	Sep 27 onward	wake 3:30 AM	lights out 8:45 PM	Study 1+2 → full 90 min

◆ DEEP WORK – THE TWO MISSIONS ☐ STOCK MARKET STUDY ☐ INTERVIEW PREP & CODING

◇ 25 MORNING RULE Today's rule from the 25 Daily Rules. Read. Absorb. Apply. → # _____

◇ SPEAK ALOUD

On waking: Thanks – universe, everyone, five elements.

Morning • Ikigai: "I am not trying to win. I am refusing to stop."

Pre-workout: Box breathing 4-4-4-4 ×5 → go.

5:20 PM (wrap-up): "Shutdown complete."

Morning & Night • Ho'oponopono: "I love you. I'm sorry. Please forgive me. Thank you."

Kaizen: "Tomorrow I improve one thing by 1%."

◇ FOOD CODE

Rice OK • no fried • no processed sugar

Chew 32× • no phone/laptop while eating

Hara Hachi Bu – eat to 80% full

Lunch = **biggest meal** (athlete portion) • 5 PM top-up on big days

Night = **milk + paneer only** – nothing after

Shata Pada – 100 steps after every meal

Warm water only w/ meals – never cold (Agni)

Protein ×4 meals – whey / paneer / dahi / sattv

Eat order: salad+dal first • roti last • millet > white rice

Tea/coffee ≥1h from meals • **last caffeine 2 PM**

Water ~3L/day • 1 anthocyanin fruit (jamun/berries/amla)

◇ ANCHORS

Sleep: lights out 9:45 PM • Fri+Sat 15 min earlier → wake 4:30 AM (6.5h = covenant floor)

Wake before 4:30 AM – no snooze, ever

Swim 6:00 SHARP daily exc WED • WED long run 5AM • TUE run 4:15PM • TUE/THU/FRI gym 7:30 • SAT ride 60-90' • SUN TRI (ride+brick) • market 9-3

Races: HM Sep 27 • TMM Jan 17 • 70.3 Feb 17

No sleep 4 AM – 5 PM (watch-tracked)

Brahmacharya – Ojas conserved & raised

The wake is decided at 9:45 PM the night before – not at the alarm

★ = tier-1, non-negotiable

◇ WRITE – FILL THROUGH THE DAY

4:45 _____ one thing

Micro-gratitude

Night • _____

3 wins

Tomorrow, _____

1% better

RAMP WEEK 1 – the times below are the full 3:30 chain. This week you wake at 4:30 AM: run the oral-care and Brahma Muhurta blocks in the order printed, just 60 min later. Study 1+2 absorbs the entire cut – nothing else shrinks. From 5:40 (pre-train) onward the sheet is exact: the 6:00 water and the 9:00 open do not move. WEDNESDAY is the exception – the long run goes at 5:00 and cannot shift, so there is NO study block: wake, minimum rituals, out the door.

WAKE – ORAL CARE (3:30-3:45) ☐ 3:30 Alarm – Wake immediately * ☐ 3:30 Wake gratitude - thank the universe ☐ 3:31 Tongue scraper (copper) ☐ 3:32 Oil pull (coconut oil) ☐ 3:33 Cold water dive reflex * ☐ 3:35 Spit oil pull + rinse ☐ 3:36 Brush teeth ☐ 3:37 Fenugreek water (soaked overnight) ☐ 3:40 Collagen 15g + amla (vit C) ☐ 3:42 Pre-run hydration – 500-750ml + pinch of salt

17 items

PRE-LUNCH RESET (12:00-1:25) ☐ 12:00 Posture reset + desk ergonomics ☐ 12:05 20-20-20 eye rule ☐ 12:10 Hydration check (750ml by noon) ☐ 1:00 Standing stretch (5 min) ☐ 1:10 Box breathing (2 min)

31 items

EVENING – 7 PM SHUTDOWN ☐ 7:00 Laptop close – HARD STOP * ☐ 7:01 PHONE OFF → hall drawer (lives in the HALL, travels nowhere; ON 9:00) * ☐ 7:02 Internet OFF ☐ 7:10 Shata Pada (100 steps)

SATURDAY ☐ SAT Laundry – wash + dry ☐ SAT Sun-tri prep – bottles + bike in car · lights out 8:30 ☐ SAT Hamnam scrub – kessa mitt full body ☐ SAT Brahmi/Bhringraj hair oiling – overnight ☐ SAT Kesar + raw milk face mask – 15 min ☐ SAT Car interior clean

◇ 25 LONGEVITY PILLARS				the foundation – read weekly			
1	Wake before sunrise	5	Pranayama (Nadi Shodhana)	9	Hara Hachi Bu (eat to 80%)	13	Turmeric + black pepper
2	Tongue scraping (copper)	6	Meditation (Vipassana)	10	Triphala before bed	14	Intermittent fasting (16:8)
3	Oil pulling (Gandusha)	7	Zone-2 cardio	11	Ashwagandha	15	Abhyanga (oil massage)
4	Cold water exposure	8	Sunlight – first 30 min	12	Green tea (matcha)	16	Sleep – before 10 PM
17	Nasya (nasal oil)	22	Earthing / grounding	23	Amla (daily)	24	Japa / mantra
18	Strength training 3x/wk	25	Ikigai – purpose	26	Forest bathing (weekly)	27	Qigong / Tai Chi
19	Ekadashi fast (2x/mo)						
20	Qigong / Tai Chi						

◇ KEY PRACTICES – how to do them			
Box breathing: in 4 · hold 4 · out 4 · hold 4 – x5 rounds Cyclic sighing: 2 short nose inhales → 1 long mouth exhale – 5 min	Nadi Shodhana: alternate-nostril, equal in/out – 5 min Kapalabhati: sharp exhales, passive inhale – 30-50	Trataka: steady gaze on candle flame, no blink – 5 min Marma: Ajna · Hridaya · Nabhi – 30s each, clockwise	Mula Bandha: root lock – engage 10s, release – 10 reps Shata Pada: 100 gentle steps after every meal

